

ACTUAL WORK BEYOND CHATTING

● AI assistants are not chatbots, they act on your behalf

● Run locally on the computer with shell access

● Connect to WhatsApp, Telegram, Slack, email and calendar

● Use LLMs (Claude/ Gemini/ChatGPT) to reason and plan

● Can build websites, presentations, workflows autonomously

● Keep “thinking” via a heartbeat loop, not just on prompt

thropic has released Claude in Chrome, a browsing agent; Claude in Excel, a spreadsheet agent; and Cowork, a desktop tool designed to automate file and task management. Agentic AI has long been one of the industry’s biggest ambitions, but so far most high-profile attempts have struggled to move beyond demos. Open-

Claw’s sudden success has caught the industry off-guard, coming just as Anthropic’s Claude Cowork sent shockwaves through global software and IT stocks, sharpening investor focus on how quickly AI agents could disrupt traditional enterprise workflows.

According to *The Aidea of India: Outlook 2026* report by EY and the Confederation of Indian Industry, enterprises are rapidly moving from experimentation with AI to execution, with 47% of organisations now running multiple GenAI use cases in production and another 10% already scaling them across the business.

Nearly three out of four business leaders (76%) believe GenAI will have a significant business impact, while 91% say speed of deployment is now the single biggest factor driving buying decisions, signalling an urgency to embed AI directly into workflows.

This shift is extending beyond copilots into autonomous systems. The survey found that 24% of Indian enterprises are already actively deploying Agentic AI, while another 46% are using AI embedded in multi-step workflows. The report describes AI agents as “the most radical promise of this era: a workforce without limits, always available, always learning, and infinitely scalable,” arguing that they enable organisations to move from assistive automation to goal-driven execution. Globally, too, the momentum is accelerating. Around 82% of organisations say they are expanding their use of AI agents, and about 75% of employees say they are comfortable working alongside AI ‘coworkers’.

For enterprises, the implication is structural. The report notes that AI is already selectively displacing outsourced and standardised work, with 64% of companies seeing an impact in functions such as customer service and back-office operations, while redirecting expenditure toward automation and efficiency rather than eliminating internal teams.

But beneath the excitement lies something more complex. This is a tool that tech insiders say is thrilling and unnerving, powerful and precarious. Its potential to deliver companies to the Promised Land comes with the risk of making their systems vulnerable.

NOT A CHATBOT. AN AGENT

The distinction between a chatbot and an agent matters. ChatGPT answers questions. Claude writes essays. OpenClaw completes tasks. “In traditional chatbots, you provide a prompt, they reply,” explains Bode, Senior Vice President of global digital services firm Sutherland and a 15-year veteran of Infosys. “You give an agent objectives and boundaries; it remembers context; it takes action across tools; and it keeps going until it completes the job.”

Hepburn, Co-founder and CEO of RAIN Ventures, an AI venture studio, puts it more bluntly. “This is the closest thing to an autonomous AI agent I’ve experienced, a Jarvis/Ironman-style assistant,” SAYS Hepburn.

The difference becomes clear in practice. When Hepburn asked Neo to check his latest downloads and understand what he was working on, it pulled context from files and transcripts stored on his